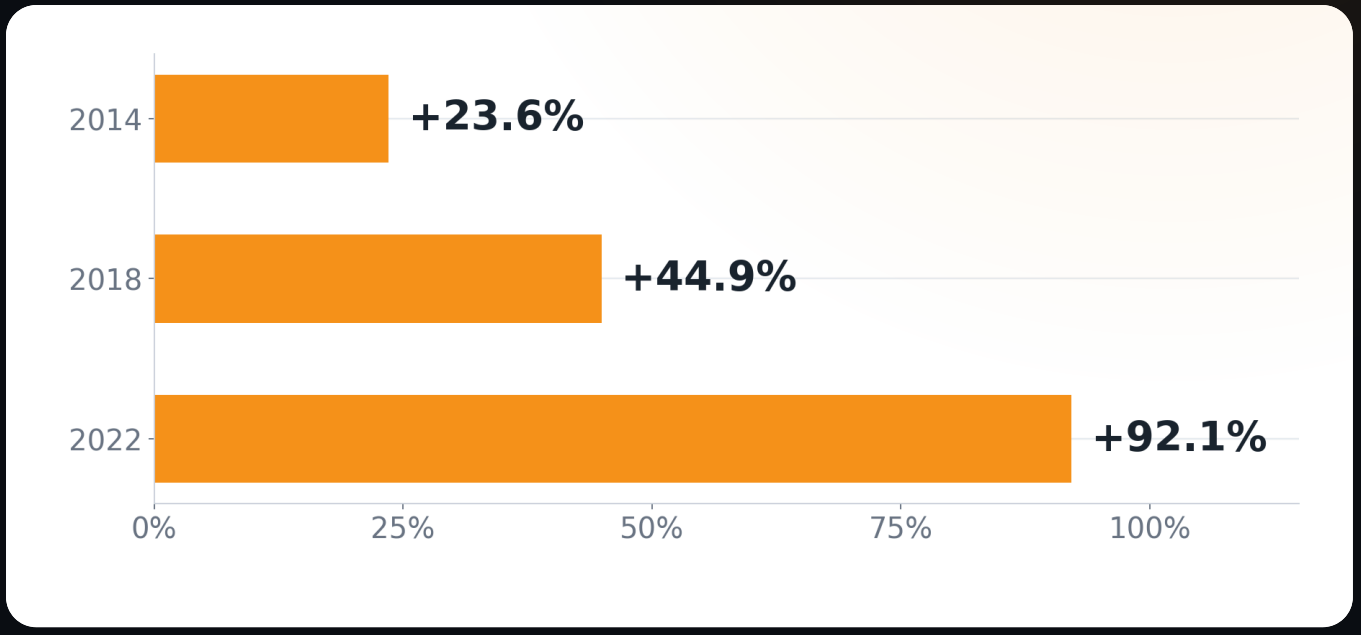
THE MIDTERM STUDY

What happened to Bitcoin and the S&P 500 after past U.S. midterm elections.

The election was yesterday. Here is the long-term record, the selling that came first, and the levels I am watching on this bounce.



3 of 3
Bitcoin higher after 365 days

+44.9%
Median Bitcoin one-year gain

19 of 19
S&P higher after 365 days

Bitcoin sample covers 2014, 2018 and 2022. Stocks cover 1950 to 2022. Historical results are not odds for this year.

Bitcoin Jae
@bitcoin.daily

STOCKS

EVERY MIDTERM SINCE 1950

The S&P 500 was higher 365 days later after all 19 midterms. The median price gain was **14.5%**. It was also higher at the 182-day mark in all 19 cases.

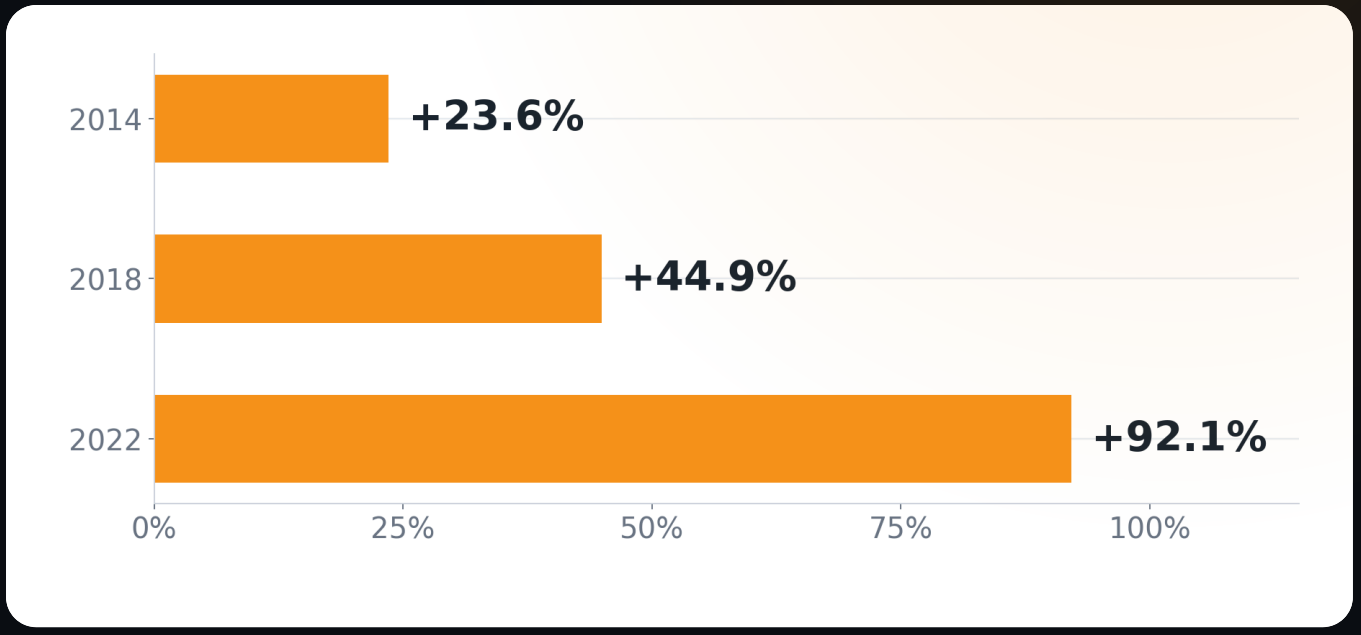
MIDTERM YEAR	182 DAYS LATER	365 DAYS LATER
1950	+16.8%	+16.2%
1954	+18.6%	+33.2%
1958	+12.0%	+11.1%
1962	+19.0%	+24.8%
1966	+15.9%	+12.9%
1970	+23.2%	+12.7%
1974	+18.0%	+18.7%
1978	+5.7%	+6.4%
1982	+18.1%	+19.9%
1986	+20.0%	+1.1%
1990	+21.1%	+25.1%
1994	+12.4%	+27.1%
1998	+19.9%	+22.0%
2002	+2.1%	+14.9%
2006	+9.0%	+6.7%
2010	+13.7%	+3.7%
2014	+3.8%	+4.5%
2018	+4.7%	+11.7%
2022	+7.6%	+14.5%

Price-only returns, dividends excluded. Median means the middle result. Entry uses the Election Day close or, when the market was closed, the last available close on or before that date.

BITCOIN

THE THREE BITCOIN ELECTIONS

I am comparing 2014, 2018 and 2022. Bitcoin was higher one year after all three. The median gain was **44.9%**.



YEAR	30 DAYS	91 DAYS	182 DAYS	365 DAYS
2014	+11.8%	-31.0%	-28.8%	+23.6%
2018	-46.7%	-46.8%	-10.8%	+44.9%
2022	-7.1%	+25.3%	+49.1%	+92.1%

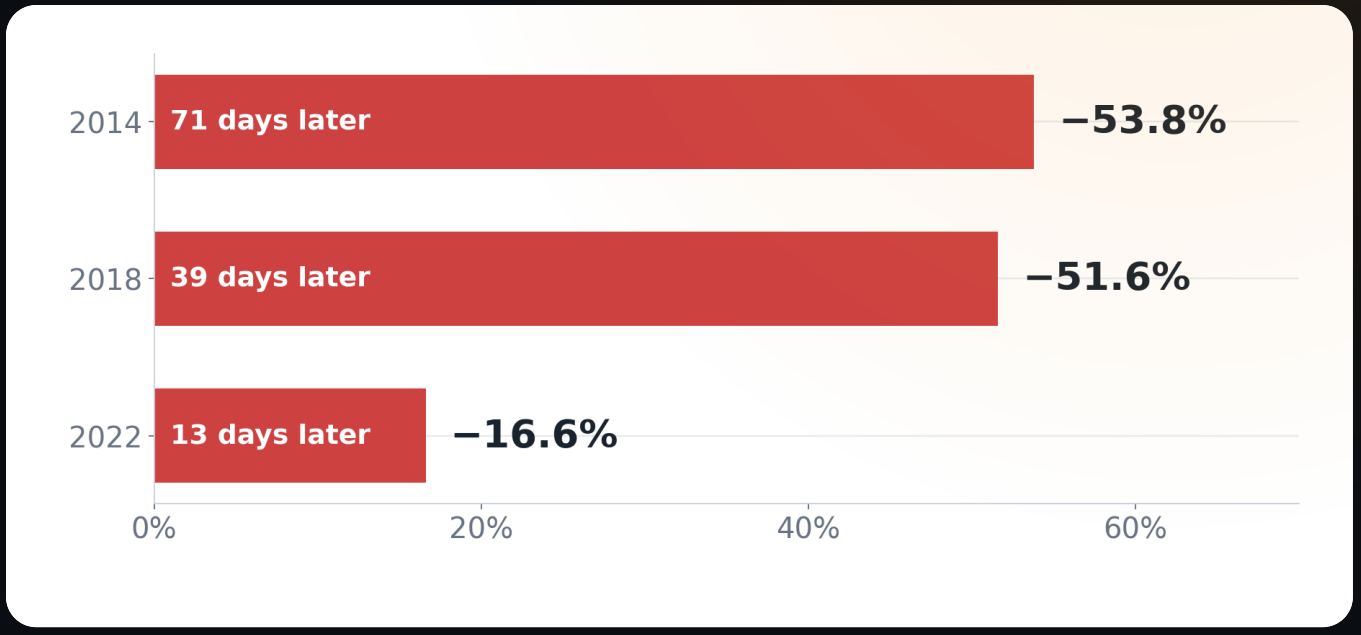
At 30, 91 and 182 days, only **one of three** was higher at each point. In 2014 and 2018, Bitcoin was still below its Election Day close six months later.

2010 is excluded from this comparison. Three elections are a small sample. Returns use calendar days, not calendar months.

THE SELLING THAT CAME FIRST

ELECTION DAY WAS NOT THE LOW

In all three bear-market midterms, the final cycle low came after the election. Bitcoin fell another **53.8%, 51.6% and 16.6%** from the election-day close before those lows.



YEAR	ELECTION CLOSE	LOW DATE	WICK LOW	DELAY	FURTHER FALL
2014	$330.22	2015-01-14	$152.40	71 days	-53.8%
2018	$6,447.50	2018-12-15	$3,122.28	39 days	-51.6%
2022	$18,550.00	2022-11-21	$15,479.00	13 days	-16.6%

The carousel rounds those falls to 54%, 52% and 17%. A positive one-year return did not mean the selloff was already over on Election Day.

Bitstamp BTC/USD. This is the fall after Election Day, not the full bear-market drawdown. The later low uses an intraday wick.

WHY TIMING NEEDS CONTEXT

TWO CALENDARS OVERLAP

The 2014, 2018 and 2022 elections also fell during Bitcoin bear markets, roughly two years after their preceding halvings. That makes it hard to separate an election effect from the market cycle.



ELECTION	PRECEDING HALVING	LATER CYCLE LOW
2014-11-04	2012-11-28	2015-01-14
2018-11-06	2016-07-09	2018-12-15
2022-11-08	2020-05-11	2022-11-21

The record does not prove that elections caused the recoveries. It also does not prove that the halving caused them. Both dates share the same historical examples.

Three out of three describes this sample. It is not a 100% probability for what happens next.

NOVEMBER 4, 2026

MY MAP FOR THIS BOUNCE

On Bitstamp, Bitcoin went from **$75,618 last night to $81,105 this morning**. The chart uses the November 4 morning snapshot. It is not a live quote.



I am watching **$82k** as the first major weekly resistance. A break above it opens room toward the prior highs around **$88k**. If price gets rejected, I still expect another sweep of the lows.

July 1 at about **$57,735** remains a possible cycle bottom, not a confirmed one. A new low below it would rule that candidate out. The election record cannot settle whether July holds.

This is my conditional chart outlook, not a forecast produced by the three-election sample. The overnight-to-morning range is not an executable trading return.

HOW THIS WAS MEASURED

THE DATES, PRICES AND LIMITS

1. Start from each Election Day close. For a closed stock-market date, use the last available close on or before that date.
2. Measure returns 30, 91, 182 and 365 calendar days later. For a non-trading end date, use the last available close on or before that date.
3. Measure the later Bitcoin lows from Election Day close to intraday wick low. Keep these separate from close-to-close returns.
4. Keep all three selected Bitcoin elections and all 19 stock elections. These counts do not provide a probability for 2026.

Bitcoin daily bars use UTC dates. S&P closes use U.S. trading sessions. Results exclude dividends, fees, slippage and taxes. No entry or exit strategy is backtested here.

Sources are Bitstamp BTC/USD OHLC, Yahoo historical S&P index closes, and the original Bitcoin Daily midterm research. J.P. Morgan Asset Management also discusses the stock return record in its October 7, 2026 midterm note.

Current-market snapshot retrieved November 4, 2026 at 10:54 a.m. America/New_York. Historical tables use fixed past data. Educational research, not personalized financial advice.

BITCOIN DAILY

COME FIND ME

This is the kind of breakdown I do every day. The hype brings the noise. I bring the data.

BD

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